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The Spirit Remains

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The Spirit Remains

Today's Reading: John 1:29-34

Hearing God's Voice for Today:

"And John bore witness: 'I saw the Spirit descend from heaven like a dove, and it remained on him.'"

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When John the Baptist saw Jesus walking toward him, John exclaimed that he is the Lamb of God who takes away the sins of the world. He foresaw Christ's substitutionary death on the cross for all the world's sins to be forgiven.

That includes your sins as well. No matter what you've done, if you confess your sins to him and ask for forgiveness, you are forever forgiven.

His Spirit enters your heart. You now have a personal relationship with Jesus for all eternity. He promises that he will never leave you or forsake you.

This promise was evidenced when John baptized Jesus. As he did so, the Spirit descended from heaven and remained upon Jesus and in him.

During every moment of Jesus' earthly ministry, the Spirit empowered his life and obedience to his Father in heaven. Their hearts were interlocked in perfect union. The Spirit never left him. He was always with him—no matter what temptation or trial he would face.

When you receive Jesus as the perfect Lamb of God who takes away the sins of the world, the same Holy Spirit who remained with and in him will remain with and in you as well. There is no sin you can ever commit to cause him to leave you. He will be with you constantly no matter what temptation or trial you may face. He is God's promised presence for all his children who believe in Jesus.

The Spirit empowers your life to be a witness for Jesus. He abides in you and causes a perfect union life between you and the Lord.

Today, no matter what you are facing, know you face it with Jesus' presence in you. He will confront all your problems with you, comforting you with his strength and encouraging your heart to persevere and never give up. He is for you. He is on your

side. He will constantly whisper to your heart that all will work together for your good and his glory.

Jesus will guide you forever. Until your last day on earth, he will be your eternal presence. He directs the steps of the godly. He will show you the proper path, even if you should go astray. He delights in overseeing every detail of your life.

Jesus' life is in you. Your life is in him. You are forever enjoined as one. He has baptized you with his Holy Spirit. Make your plans today.

But know Jesus determines your steps. He will guide you along the best pathway for your life. He will advise and watch over you. Hold his right hand. Trust he is leading you. That should bring his perfect peace to your heart.

You can trust Jesus today.

*[from "**Hearing the Voice of God**" by Pastor David Chadwick, Moments of Hope Church, Charlotte, NC]*